

Picking a Topic: Paper Proposals and Research Paper Overview

AR 280 Summer Session 2

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In this Class...

Paper Proposals

- Expectations and due date

Meeting with your Facilitator (Week 4)

Research Paper Overview

- Requirements, Expectations, Grading, etc.

Paper Proposal

- Due Sunday **July 19th @ 11:59 PM EST**
- Worth 5% of your final research paper grade
- The research paper will ask you to find an archaeological topic related to the use of food, drink, or drugs about which you would like to learn more. You must write a formal proposal for this paper following the provided template, which will allow your facilitator to help you refine your topic.



Scope of the Proposal

- This proposal should explain what topic you have chosen to explore, identify the tentative research question you have developed as the focus for your paper, cite two scholarly articles or books that you have consulted (with full bibliographic information), and briefly describe the approach you will take to complete your research.
 - Your research question should provide you with a tentative thesis statement for the proposal
- Course Policy on Gen AI use applies to this assignment



Format

- Your proposal should be one paragraph in length, approximately 100-200 words. You should use complete sentences, and you may simply refer to the authors of the scholarly articles or books you have chosen as needed. You should, of course, proofread your writing before submission but you will not be graded on style, just content and completeness. You must include full, formal bibliographic entries for each source you will use.



Sample Proposal: Food in Viking Greenland

Identify what their topic is and what specific aspect of food is of most interest to them

Food in Viking Greenland

As the title suggests, what I want to examine for my research is Greenland. Specifically, I want to look at meat in particular. This is interesting number of both marine and terrestrial options that were available to the I want to look at what specifically changed over time and if there are any reasons for this change, whether environmental or other. This will largely be done through a **zooarchaeological approach (Arneborg et al. 2012), as well as** **studies of the bone chemistry of the people in these areas** **(Arneborg et al. 1999).** Both options will allow me to see terrestrial and marine inputs to the diet.

Posit research questions: are there changes over time in meat consumption? Is this change caused by the environment or a different cause?

Conclude by identifying what types of archaeological data they will be using to answer their question(s)

Sample Proposal: Bibliography

- Arneborg, Jette, Jan Heinemeier, Niels Lynnerup, Henrik L Nielsen, Niels Rud, and Ámy E Sveinbjornsdottir. 1999. "Change of Diet of the Greenland Vikings Determined from Stable Carbon Isotope Analysis and ^{14}C Dating of Their Bones." *Radiocarbon* 41 (2): 157-168.
- Arneborg, Jette, Niels Lynnerup, and Jan Heinemeier. 2012. "Human Diet and Subsistence Patterns in Norse Greenland AD c. 980—AD c. 1450: Archaeological Interpretations." *Journal of the North Atlantic* 3: 119-133.

TIPS FOR CHOOSING A TOPIC

Start with an Artifact

What food related artifact interests you?

- (Ex.) Bread ovens in Rome
 - How do archaeologists study them?
 - What does this object tell us about eating or drinking in that world?

Start with a System & ZOOM IN

How did an ancient food system work?

- Who produced the food? Who ate it?
- How was food stored?
- What if the system broke down?
- (Ex.) The role of bakers in the Roman food system

Start with a Question

(Ex.) What was it like to be a baker in Rome?

- Who did the baking?
- What tools did they use?
- How important was bread to Roman life?

Start with Your Interests

What modern foods do you care about?

- How was this food made, consumed, or even understood in the ancient world?
- (Ex.) I love baking bread! – What role did bread play in the ancient Rome?

CONSTRUCTING A THESIS STATEMENT

1

Brainstorm: Start with a System!

- What elites ate in the Roman Empire. What were their foodways like?
 - This does NOT tell the reader what you want to say about Roman foodways...

2

Narrow the Topic

- What did elites in Rome eat compared to elites in Roman Britain?
 - This will probably require some initial research...

3

Take a Position on the Topic

- Wealthy people in Roman Britain ate a more local and simpler diet than elites in Rome, who had access to more imported and exotic foods.
 - How will you choose to support this claim? What methods will you look at?
 - Stable isotope analysis data? Zooarchaeological remains? Trade records?

CONSTRUCTING A THESIS STATEMENT

4

Using Specific & Argumentative Language:

- GENERAL STATEMENT: “Elites in the Roman Empire ate different kinds of food.”
 - Too vague! This is very broad and doesn’t say who, where, why, or how...
 - What are you arguing?
- SPECIFIC & ARGUMENTATIVE STATEMENT: “Evidence from isotopes, zooarchaeological remains, and historical records show that even though elites in both Rome and Roman Britain were a part of the same social class, local customs, geography, and trade shaped their diets in different ways.”
 - Includes multiple methods
 - Argument is clear
 - Specific group(s) is/are named
 - So What? - Social status alone does not determine diet! Location matters too!

MORE RESOURCES

Choosing a Topic

- [Selecting a Research Topic: MIT Libraries](#)
- [Choosing a Topic: Purdue OWL](#)

Research & Citations

- [Mugar Archaeology Research Guide](#)
- [Citing Sources](#)
- [How to Avoid Plagerism](#)

Writing a Thesis Statement

- [How to Write a Thesis Statement: Indiana University Bloomington](#)
- [Developing a Thesis: Harvard College Writing Center](#)

Finding Accessible Scholarly Sources



baking ancient rome



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Baking and cooking

N Monteix - A companion to food in the **ancient** world, 2015 - Wiley Online Library

This chapter reviews the interlinked and complementary study of literary, epigraphic, and material sources that allows one to understand the slow diffusion of bread as the preferred ...

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Testa and clibani: the **baking covers of classical Italy**

AL Cubberley, JA Lloyd, PC Roberts - ... of the British School at **Rome**, 1988 - cambridge.org

... between **Roman** sub testu cooking and the Medieval **baking** ... of **Roman** clibani have varied enormously (below, p. 104) ... the same object, the simple **baking** cover. In section III recently ...

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The Bread Makers: The Social and Professional Lives of Bakers in the Western **Roman Empire**

JT Benton - 2020 - Springer

... For the study of **ancient Roman** industries, the growing use ... -**Roman** traditions were not informing commercial **baking** in ... the **baking** process, such as clay ovens used in **Roman** forts on ...

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" Our Daily Bread" in Italy: Its Meaning in the **Roman Period and Today**

C Manetta - Material Culture, 2016 - JSTOR

... **Baking** and bakeries pervaded daily life in **Ancient Rome** and were palpable in sound, sight, touch, smell, and taste. The large number of bakeries documented in **Roman** cities can be ...

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Cooking and **baking technology**

J Paulas - ... , and Medicine in **Ancient** Greece and **Rome**, 2016 - Wiley Online Library

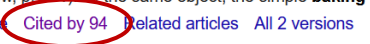
... In addition to larger herd animals (pecus), many other types of animal were bred by the **ancients**. We have far more evidence from **roman** times in authors such as Varro and Columella, ...

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Home-baking in **Roman Italy**

JM Frayn - Antiquity, 1978 - cambridge.org

... in Italy in the **Roman** period. Methods of **baking** as practised commercially in **Roman** towns of





horbat rosh zayit



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1



BOOK

Horbat Rosh Zayit : an Iron Age storage fort and village ; 1st ed.

Gal, Zvi, (author) ; Alexandre, Y. (Yardenna) (author) ; Baruch, U. (Uri) (contributor)

2000

Series: IAA reports

[Online Access Available](#)



2



BOOK

Stone Vessels in the near East During the Iron Age and the Persian Period : (C. 1200-330 BCE). ; 1st ed.

Squitieri, Andrea.

2017

Series: Archaeopress Ancient near Eastern Archaeology

[Online Access Available](#)



3



REFERENCE ENTRY

Horbat Rosh Zayit ; 1

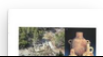
The Oxford Encyclopedia of the Bible and Archaeology, 2013

“ The archaeological context and historical background of Horbat Rosh Zayit (Arabic Khirbat Ras ez-Zeitun...”

[Online Access Available](#)



4



BOOK CHAPTER

Appendix 5: Fish Bones from horbat Rosh Zayit





- TOP
- VIEW ONLINE
- MORE INFO
- SEND TO
- DETAILS
- VIRTUAL BROWSE

BOOK

Horbat Rosh Zayit : an Iron Age storage fort and village ; 1st ed.

Gal, Zvi, (author) ; Alexandre, Y. (Yardenna) (author) ; Baruch, U. (Uri) (contributor)

2000

Series: IAA reports

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CITATIONS



Meeting with your Facilitator

- Following the submission of your paper proposal by **July 19th, 11:59pm ET**, you need to schedule a meeting with your Facilitator during their office hours (use the links on Blackboard)
 - Please, schedule these meetings ASAP!
- Facilitators will review your paper proposal with you and help you to hone your research agenda prior to beginning your work on the research paper
 - Meetings may vary, but on average will last about 5-15 mins
 - Great time to ask questions and clarify any confusion about the paper!
- This meeting is also part of your Paper Proposal grade (worth 5% of your final grade)

Expanded Office Hours (in EST)

- Peter:

- Mon (7/20) 11am–12pm
- Tue (7/21) 5-6pm
- Wed (7/22) 10am–12pm
- Thu (7/23) 11am–12pm

Can find the Calendly links in the **“Facilitator Live Office Hours”** section on Blackboard under the **“Live Classroom and Offices”** section

- Wed (7/22) 9am - 1pm

- Mon (7/20) 10am - 12pm
- Tue (7/21) 11am - 2pm
- Wed (7/22) 10am - 12pm

Research Paper

- The paper is due as a draft by **August 2nd at 11:59 PM ET**
 - The final revised version of the paper is due **FRIDAY August 14th at 11:59 PM ET**
- **LATE SUBMISSIONS ARE NOT PERMITTED**
- In total, the Research Paper is worth **25% of your Final Grade**
- **Your final grade on the paper is an average of the rough and final draft scores**



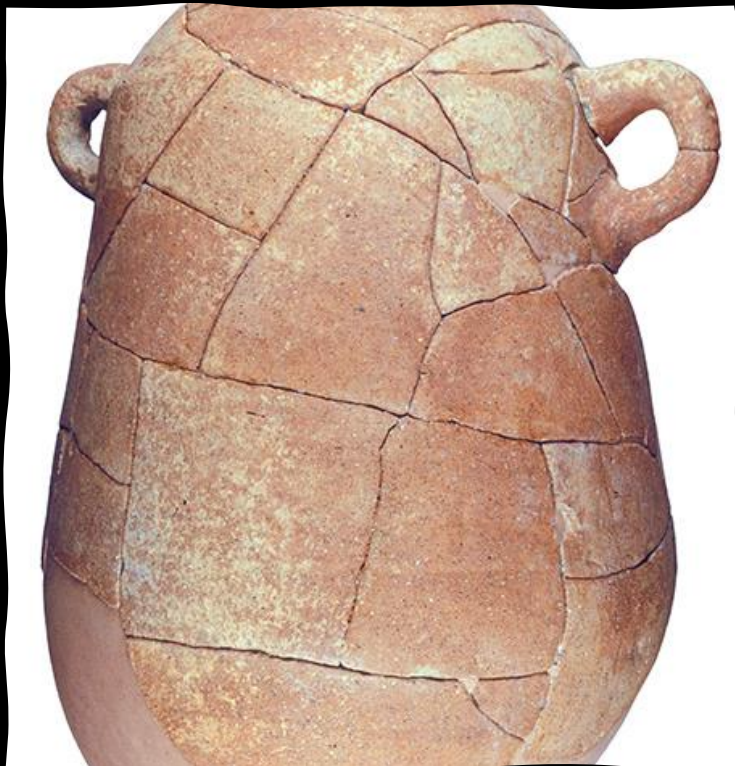
Scope of the Paper

Choose an archaeological topic related to food, drink, or medicines, develop a research question, and address that question in a well-written paper. You have complete freedom on the topic you choose with some exceptions:

- 1) The question and sources you draw on must deal primarily with **archaeological evidence** (although other evidence types, such as historical documents, can also serve as evidence)
- 2) You must find at least **five** academic articles, books, or book chapters beyond those assigned in this class (although you may also cite readings from class in addition to these)
- 3) You may **NOT** draw on non-scholarly sources of evidence, including journalistic writing or online video content, without advance permission from your instructor

From the Paper Proposal:

- You're going to select a topic, research question, and will identify what lines of evidence you'll be using
- You will have found two scholarly sources relevant to your chosen topic



Questions?